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ARTICLE

Identify Different Scams, Misinformation or Spam Online

Learn how to spot different types of online messages, including scams and misinformation, and check out real examples that have been circulating recently — so you can stay alert and avoid falling for false or harmful content.

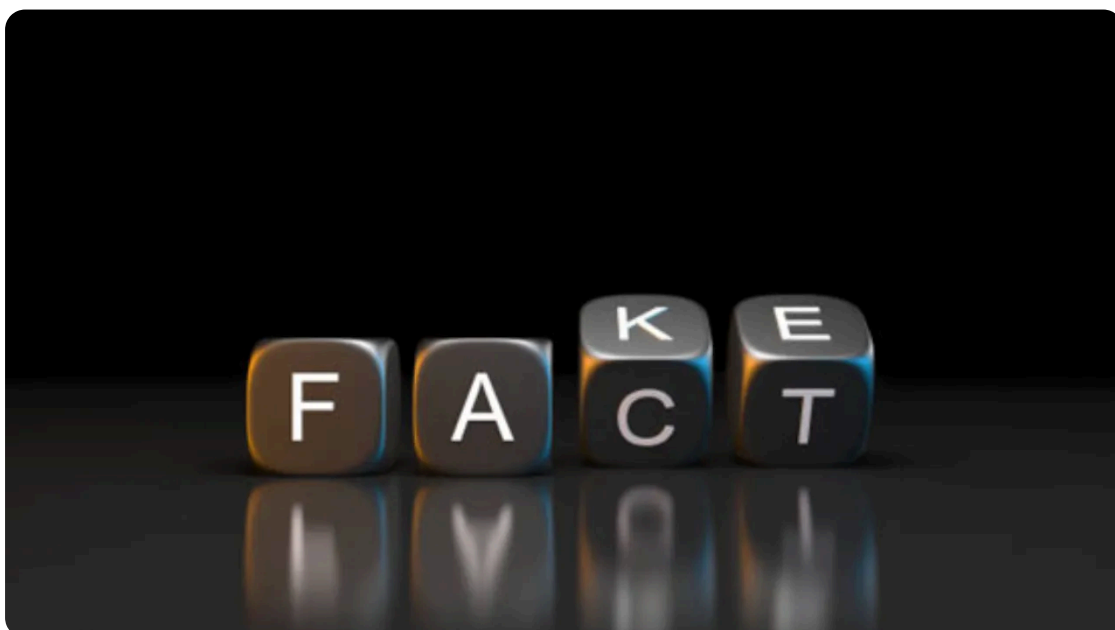
01 Jun 2025

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Identify different types of messages/news online to discern scams and misinformation, as well as examples of these scams/misinformation messages that have been circulating in the digital space recently.

Scams

Scam messages are deceptive communications designed to trick you into sharing personal information, giving money, or clicking harmful links. They can appear as emails, texts or social media messages, often pretending to be from trusted organisations like banks, delivery services or government agencies.

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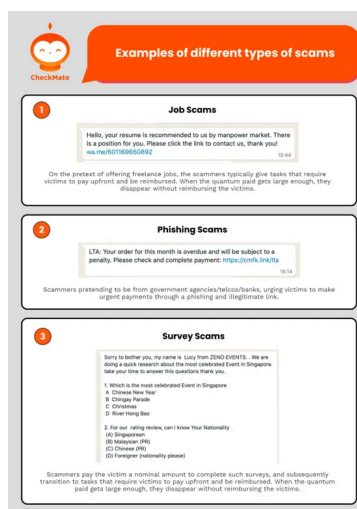
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personal
information

- Contain an attractive offer such as a prize or money
- Could require urgent action
- Contain strange grammar or spelling mistakes
- Include a link that is most likely shortened or scrambled



Illicit

Illicit messages refer to advertisements that are linked to potential illicit activities, such as moneylending, online

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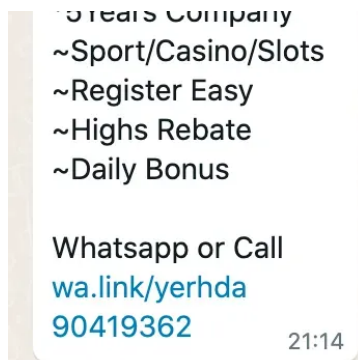
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Misinformation

When evaluating a piece of information or message online, it's important to recognise that not all information is strictly 100% true or 100% false. Instead, reliability often exists on a spectrum. Some content may be entirely accurate, while others could be partially true, misleading or completely false.

For example, a piece of information might include verified facts but present them out of context to distort

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approach fact-
checking more
critically.

Look for cues like
credible sources,
balanced reporting,
and corroboration
from multiple
trustworthy outlets.
Avoid assuming that
just because a claim
seems plausible or is
widely shared, it must
be true. Fact-
checking isn't just
about finding "yes" or
"no" answers—it's
about assessing how
trustworthy a piece of
information is and
where it falls on the
reliability spectrum.



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Satire



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caricatures of people.
Satirical content may
not be entirely factual
and is likely to be
social commentary.

An example of satire:



Marketing/Spam

A spam text is a text message sent to market a particular product or service or event. They are usually unsolicited. While typically harmless, they could contain suspicious looking links:

Examples include:

- “<ADV> Singapore’s medical cost is always rising. Would you want to protect your savings and

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- "LIMITED TIME till end of this month! Save up to \$3000 on your self care. Ask your Hairstylist or <https://www.99percenthairstudio.com/super-savings>."
- "<ADV> Congrats Ming! You're one of our 3 lucky winners to receive your beauty gifts worth \$566. Redeem @ <https://t1.sg/uXXa> NOW! 1. Ming 2. Cindy T 3. Zi Hui L T&Cs apply. UNSUB sg@bonusrevpartners.com"

After reading this article, if you feel equipped to identify scams and misinformation, why not put your knowledge to good use? Report suspicious messages, claims, or content to the CheckMate WhatsApp bot [here](#), where your

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share CheckMate with your friends and loved ones, to help them separate fact from fiction, and stay safe online or take it a step further - join CheckMate as a volunteer fact-checker [here](#) and contribute to debunking scams and misinformation, making the digital world a safer place for everyone!

Useful Links

- CheckMate [Website](#)
- Join [CheckMate](#) as a fact-checker [Take Note When Fact-checking](#)
- [Information Online](#)



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